

Portugal’s General-Government Balance by Subsector, 1977–2025

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Abstract

This report decomposes Portugal’s annual general-government net lending (+) / net borrowing (-) into Central Government, Regional and Local Government, and Social Security Funds (SSF), for the 49 years from 1977 to 2025. The analysis is empirical and accounting-focused. It covers long-run balance composition, exact year-to-year attribution, revenue and expenditure dynamics, sign persistence, conservative structural mean shifts, Social Security revenue composition and internal systems, primary balances and interest, public investment, debt-flow reconciliation, and descriptive macroeconomic co-movement.

The central accounting identity is

$$B_t^{GG} = B_t^C + B_t^{RL} + B_t^{SSF},$$

and it closes for every year in the panel to within rounding. The aggregate balance is positive in 4 of 49 years: 2019, 2023, 2024 and 2025.

No causal, normative, or policy-intent interpretation is assigned to any result. Every figure and table in this report is generated from a persisted artefact listed in Appendix A; no value is transcribed by hand.

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1 Results at a Glance

Table 1: Headline quantities, each read from a persisted artefact.

Quantity	Value
Panel coverage	1977–2025
Annual observations	49
Sector-year detailed account observations	184
Years with a positive aggregate balance	4
General Government balance, 2025	2,059 M EUR (0.67% GDP)
Combined non-SSF balance, 2025	-5,006 M EUR (-1.63% GDP)
Social Security Funds balance, 2025	7,065 M EUR (2.30% GDP)
Maximum absolute subsector closure residual	1.00 M EUR
Maximum absolute account identity error	5.46e-12 M EUR
Maximum absolute debt reconciliation residual	0.00e+00 M EUR
Subsector account years left un-imputed	4 (1996–1999)

Residual quantities are validation checks on the extraction and the accounting identities, not economic results.

The three residual rows are the report’s own audit trail. The subsector identity closes to within the one-million-euro rounding of the published sources; revenue minus expenditure reproduces the recorded balance to numerical precision; and the modern debt change reconciles exactly with the balance and the stock-flow adjustment. A change in any of those rows would indicate a defect in extraction rather than a finding.

2 Data, Sources and Validation

The canonical balance panel takes 1977–1994 from the Banco de Portugal / INE historical long series and 1995–2025 from INE data distributed through PORDATA. The CFP ESA 2010 workbooks supply modern revenue, expenditure, interest, investment, Maastricht debt and stock-flow data, and act as an independent cross-check on the balance bridge. Every workbook is parsed programmatically from the bundled file; no value is transcribed.

2.1 Two statistical regimes, not one series

The statistical splice at **1995** is retained explicitly and nothing is smoothed, chained or calibrated across it. Both 1995 vintages are kept, and the revision between them is reported in Table 3. The revisions are small in level terms but non-zero for every subsector, which is why no model in this repository is fitted across the boundary.

Table 2: Bundled sources, the coverage used from each, and the first twelve hexadecimal digits of the SHA-256 digest of the retained file.

Source	Institution	Coverage used	SHA-256 prefix
Banco Portugal Long Series	Banco de Portugal / INE	1977-1995 for the historical segment used here	d3570ea90f78
PORDATA Balance By Level	INE via PORDATA	1995-2025	2a5d54649041
CFP Annual General Government	Portuguese Public Finance Council (CFP)	1995-2025	8f6b5a2916a4
CFP Annual Subsectors	Portuguese Public Finance Council (CFP)	2000-2025	4d9e1b07cd38
CFP Social Security Detail	Portuguese Public Finance Council (CFP)	2019-2025 systems; detailed 2024-2025 tables	d9f28e424ab6

Download URLs and local paths are recorded in `config/sources.yml`; full digests for every bundled file are in `outputs/metrics/raw_file_sha256.json`.

Table 3: The 1995 overlap. Both vintages are retained; the canonical panel uses the modern one.

Balance	Historical vintage (M EUR)	Modern vintage (M EUR)	Revision (M EUR)
General Government	-4,557.7	-4,611.0	-53.3
Central Government	-4,220.7	-4,235.0	-14.3
Regional and Local	32.6	66.0	33.4
Social Security Funds	-369.5	-442.0	-72.5

2.2 An explicit gap, not an interpolation

Detailed revenue and expenditure components are available for General Government from 1977 onward without interruption, but for the three subsectors only for 1977–1995 and 2000–2025. The four intervening years are absent from the sources and are therefore absent here; Figure 1 shows the gap directly.

Table 4: Coverage of the detailed account panel. The absent years are the 1996–1999 subsector components, which are missing from both sources and are not imputed.

Sector	First year	Last year	Observations	Years absent
General Government	1977	2025	49	0
Central Government	1977	2025	45	4
Regional and Local	1977	2025	45	4
Social Security Funds	1977	2025	45	4

3 Long-Run Subsector Decomposition

Over the full panel the aggregate balance is positive in 4 years: **2019, 2023, 2024 and 2025**. The Central Government balance is negative in **49 of 49 observations**, while the Social Security balance is positive in **43 observations** (Table 14 reports the full sign frequencies). These are descriptive frequencies. They are not counterfactual statements about what the aggregate balance would have been under a different institutional arrangement.

3.1 Offset metrics

Writing the combined non-Social-Security balance as $B_t^{nonSSF} = B_t^C + B_t^{RL}$, the offset ratio is defined, whenever $B_t^{nonSSF} < 0$ and $B_t^{SSF} > 0$, as

$$O_t = \frac{B_t^{SSF}}{|B_t^{nonSSF}|}.$$

$O_t = 1$ means the positive Social Security balance is exactly the size of the negative non-SSF balance. The ratio compares two recorded numbers. It is not a counterfactual, and it does not

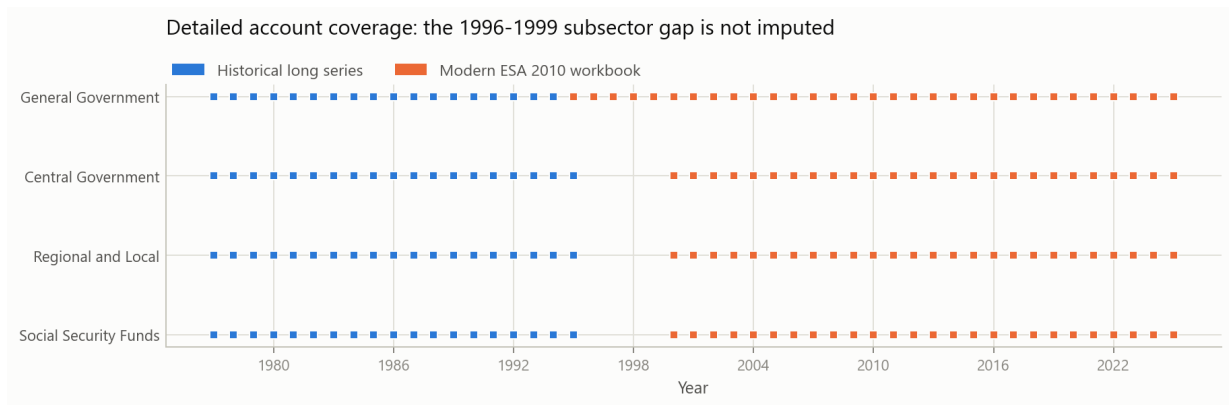


Figure 1: Detailed account coverage by sector and statistical regime.

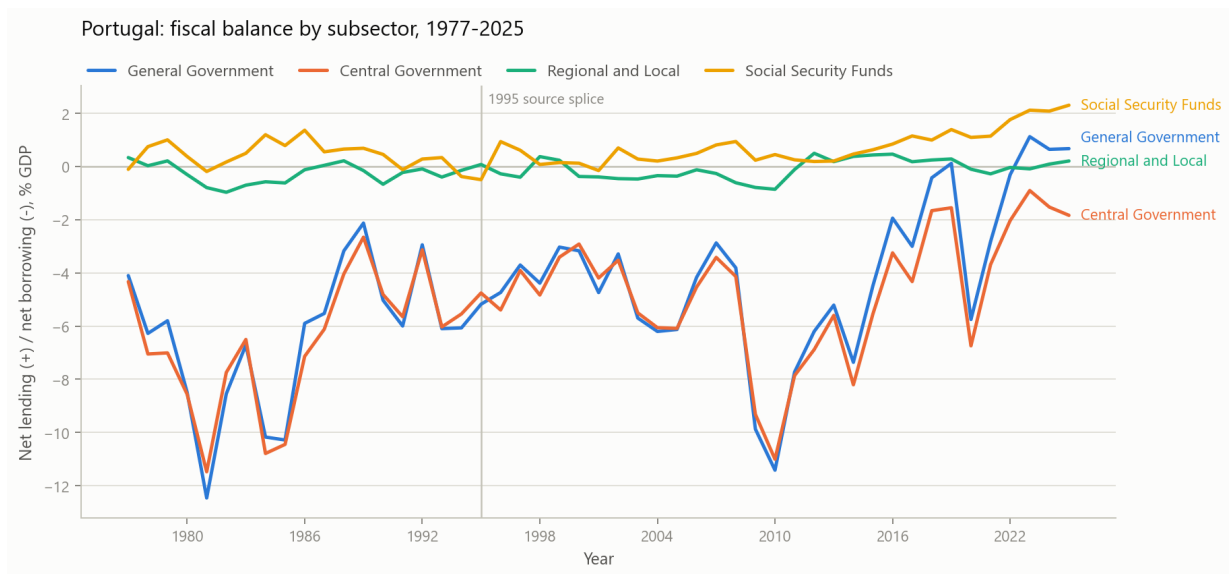


Figure 2: Net lending (+) / net borrowing (-) by subsector, as a share of GDP. The vertical rule marks the 1995 source splice.

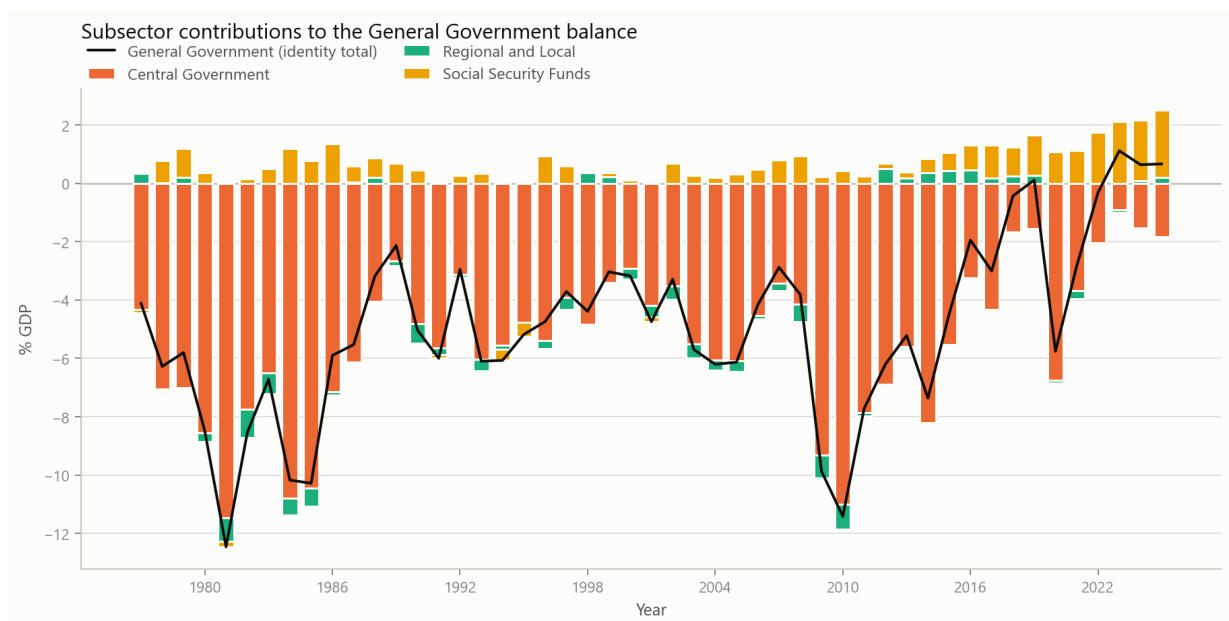


Figure 3: The identity drawn: signed subsector contributions stacked against the General Government total. A tall column under a shallow line means the subsectors offset one another that year.

describe what either balance would be under different institutional arrangements. It is undefined, and left missing, whenever the signs do not make the comparison meaningful.

In 2025 the identity reads

$$2,059 = -5,636 + 630 + 7,065 \quad \text{M EUR},$$

with a combined non-SSF balance of **-5,006 M EUR** and an offset ratio of **1.411**.

Table 5: Years with a positive aggregate balance.

Year	GG (M EUR)	Central (M EUR)	Regional/local (M EUR)	SSF (M EUR)	Non-SSF (M EUR)	Offset ratio
2019	249	-3,331	604	2,975	-2,727	1.091
2023	3,030	-2,447	-243	5,720	-2,690	2.126
2024	1,863	-4,424	256	6,031	-4,168	1.447
2025	2,059	-5,636	630	7,065	-5,006	1.411

Table 6: Subsector decomposition of the recent period.

Year	GG (M EUR)	Central (M EUR)	Regional/local (M EUR)	SSF (M EUR)	Non-SSF (M EUR)	Offset ratio
2010	-20,537	-19,799	-1,543	805	-21,342	0.038
2011	-13,624	-13,862	-201	439	-14,063	0.031
2012	-10,453	-11,603	835	314	-10,768	0.029
2013	-8,898	-9,555	309	348	-9,246	0.038
2014	-12,752	-14,214	655	808	-13,559	0.060
2015	-8,026	-9,931	776	1,129	-9,155	0.123
2016	-3,622	-6,055	863	1,570	-5,192	0.302
2017	-5,870	-8,460	348	2,243	-8,112	0.277
2018	-873	-3,407	499	2,035	-2,908	0.700
2019	249	-3,331	604	2,975	-2,727	1.091
2020	-11,564	-13,555	-207	2,198	-13,762	0.160
2021	-6,117	-7,985	-601	2,468	-8,586	0.287
2022	-757	-4,966	-91	4,299	-5,057	0.850
2023	3,030	-2,447	-243	5,720	-2,690	2.126
2024	1,863	-4,424	256	6,031	-4,168	1.447
2025	2,059	-5,636	630	7,065	-5,006	1.411

4 Year-to-Year Attribution

The annual change in the aggregate balance decomposes exactly:

$$\Delta B_t^{GG} = \Delta B_t^C + \Delta B_t^{RL} + \Delta B_t^{SSF}.$$

The decomposition is stored for every adjacent year in `outputs/tables/balance_change_attribution.csv` and closes to **1.00 M EUR** at worst. It separates the *level* of a subsector balance from its *contribution* to an annual improvement or deterioration, which are distinct questions that the level series alone cannot answer.

Contribution is not causation. A subsector accounting for most of an annual improvement has not been shown to have produced it, and the 1994-to-1995 change mixes a vintage revision with an economic movement.

5 Revenue and Expenditure Dynamics

For every sector-year with detailed components the balance is an identity, $B_{i,t} = R_{i,t} - E_{i,t}$, and therefore so is its change,

$$\Delta B_{i,t} = \Delta R_{i,t} - \Delta E_{i,t}.$$

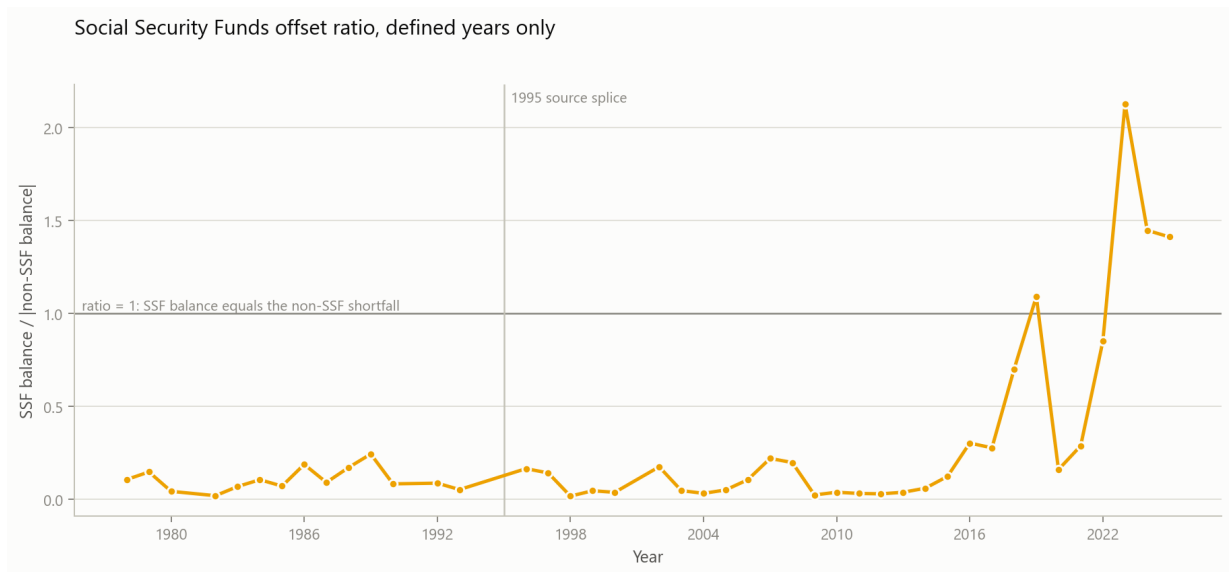


Figure 4: Social Security Funds offset ratio for the years in which it is defined.

Table 7: The eight largest annual movements in the General Government balance, and how they decompose across subsectors.

Year	Aggregate change (M EUR)	Central (M EUR)	Regional/local (M EUR)	SSF (M EUR)
2009	-10,496	-8,939	-289	-1,268
2011	6,913	5,937	1,342	-366
2015	4,726	4,283	121	321
2016	4,404	3,876	87	441
2018	4,997	5,053	151	-208
2020	-11,813	-10,224	-811	-777
2021	5,447	5,570	-394	270
2022	5,360	3,019	510	1,831

Ranked by the absolute nominal change, so the modern period dominates: nominal GDP in 2025 is orders of magnitude larger than in 1977.

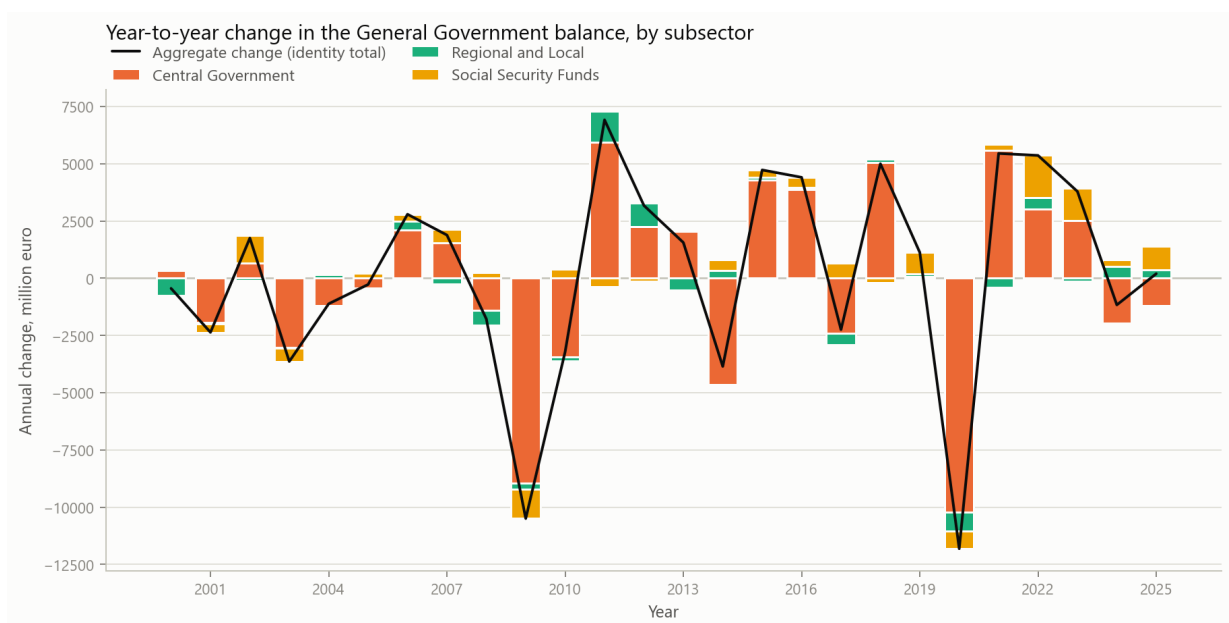


Figure 5: Annual change in the General Government balance, attributed to subsectors.

The exact annual decomposition is stored in `outputs/tables/revenue_expenditure_change_decomposition.csv` and reproduces the recorded balance change to **5.5e-12 M EUR**. Source gaps are never bridged: no change is computed across the 1995-to-2000 discontinuity in subsector components, so those rows are dropped rather than interpolated.

Table 8: Recent General Government balance changes, decomposed into revenue and expenditure changes.

Year	Change in revenue (M EUR)	Change in expenditure (M EUR)	Change in balance (M EUR)
2018	4,794	-203	4,997
2019	3,513	2,391	1,122
2020	-4,176	7,636	-11,813
2021	9,188	3,742	5,447
2022	9,898	4,539	5,360
2023	10,394	6,607	3,787
2024	7,997	9,164	-1,167
2025	8,332	8,136	196

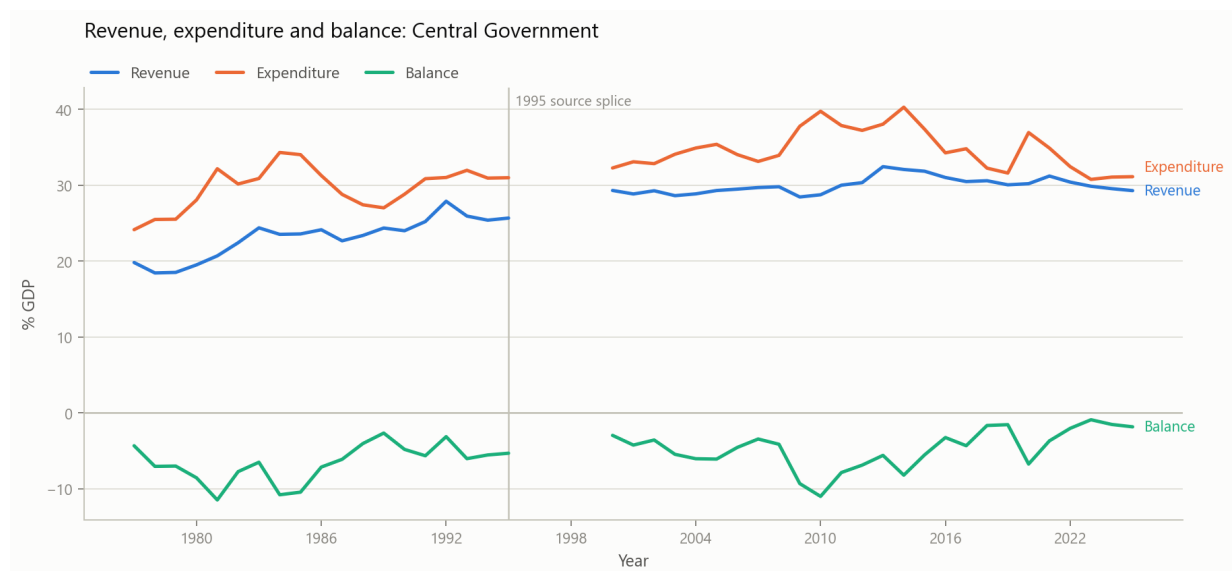


Figure 6: Central Government revenue, expenditure and balance as shares of GDP. The line breaks at 1996–1999, where subsector components do not exist.

The decomposition uses totals, so a change in revenue may reflect composition shifts that are visible only in the component columns of the account panel. It is not decomposed into policy and macroeconomic parts, which would require assumptions this repository does not make.

6 Social Security Funds: Revenue Composition and Internal Systems

6.1 National-accounts view

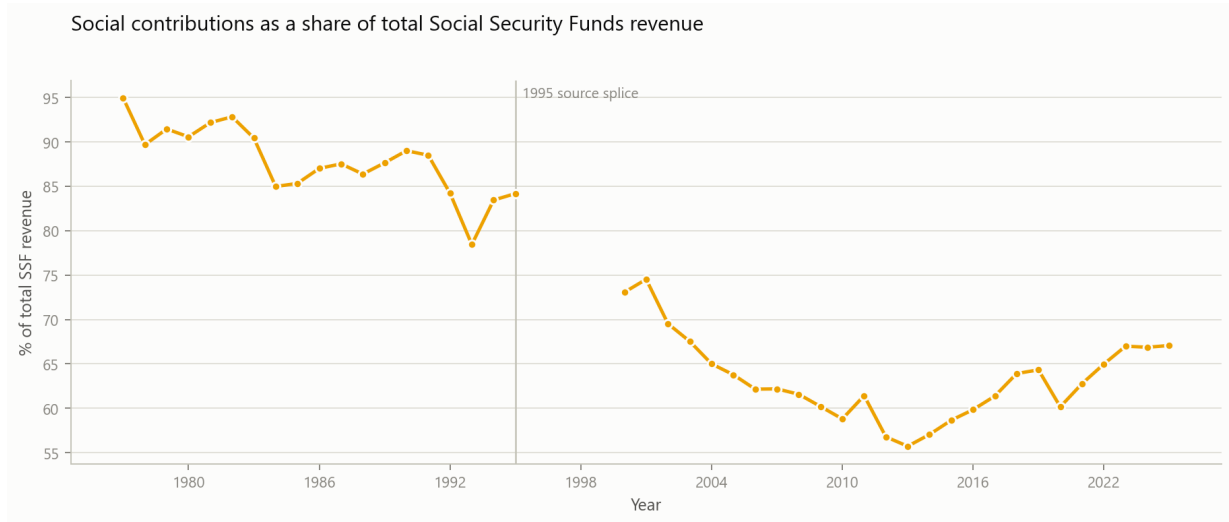
The ESA 2010 Social Security Funds sector is the entity that appears in the B.9 identity. In 2025, social contributions were **67.07%** of total SSF revenue in the account table.

6.2 A different boundary: the CFP budget systems

The CFP's Social Security report decomposes the system into the Previdential system, the Social Protection of Citizenship system, and special regimes. These are budget-execution aggregates

Table 9: Social Security Funds revenue composition, most recent years.

Year	Revenue (% GDP)	Contributions (% GDP)	Expenditure (% GDP)	Contribution share
2020	15.58	9.37	14.49	0.602
2021	14.92	9.36	13.78	0.628
2022	14.23	9.25	12.47	0.650
2023	14.01	9.38	11.89	0.670
2024	14.41	9.64	12.33	0.669
2025	14.77	9.91	12.47	0.671

**Figure 7:** Social contributions as a share of total Social Security Funds revenue.

with a different accounting boundary from the national accounts, so they are reported beside the ESA 2010 balance and never added to it. In 2025 the reported internal balances were **6,712 M EUR** (Previdential), **-55 M EUR** (Citizenship) and **0 M EUR** (special regimes).

Table 10: CFP Social Security budget systems: internal balances.

Year	Previdential (M EUR)	Citizenship (M EUR)	Special regimes (M EUR)
2019	2,333	443	0
2020	1,649	423	0
2021	1,695	653	0
2022	4,172	-110	0
2023	5,485	1	0
2024	5,840	-245	0
2025	6,712	-55	0

For the detailed 2025 budget table, providential contributions account for **92.27%** of providential revenue. The repository does not subtract State transfers from the Social Security balance and call the remainder an underlying balance: which transfer finances which statutory responsibility is a legal question, not an accounting one.

7 Primary Balance and Interest

The primary balance is reconstructed as $PB_{i,t} = B_{i,t} + I_{i,t}$, where I is interest expenditure, and then checked against the published primary-balance row. The identity holds to **0.0e+00 M EUR**,

so the separation of interest from the remaining balance is arithmetic rather than estimated.

For Central Government in 2025 the headline balance was **-5,636 M EUR**, interest expenditure was **6,364 M EUR**, and the recomputed primary balance was **728 M EUR**.

Table 11: Central Government headline balance, interest and primary balance.

Year	Balance (M EUR)	Interest (M EUR)	Primary balance (M EUR)	Interest (% GDP)	Primary balance (% GDP)
2018	-3,407	7,101	3,694	3.46	1.80
2019	-3,331	6,516	3,185	3.04	1.48
2020	-13,555	5,963	-7,592	2.97	-3.78
2021	-7,985	5,358	-2,627	2.47	-1.21
2022	-4,966	4,878	-88	2.00	-0.04
2023	-2,447	5,797	3,349	2.14	1.24
2024	-4,424	6,281	1,857	2.17	0.64
2025	-5,636	6,364	728	2.07	0.24

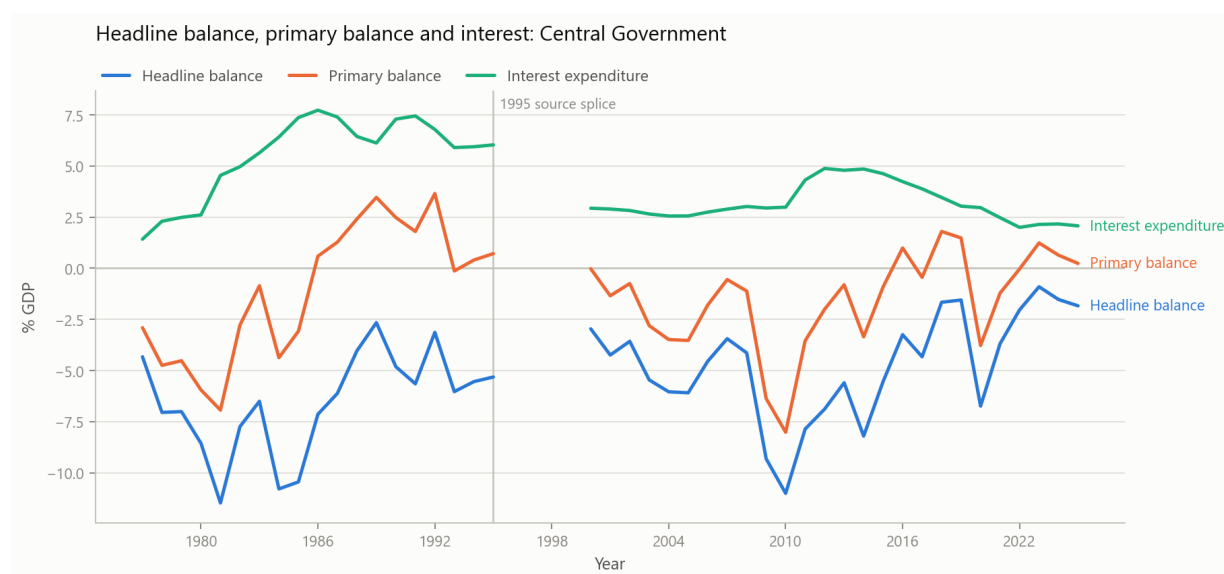


Figure 8: Central Government headline balance, primary balance and interest expenditure, as shares of GDP.

Interest is overwhelmingly a Central Government item, which is why the primary and headline balances of the other subsectors nearly coincide. The primary balance excludes interest by construction: it is not a measure of discretionary policy and not a cyclically adjusted balance, and it reflects the debt stock and financing conditions inherited from earlier periods.

8 Fixed-Capital-Formation Diagnostic

The repository reports an explicitly non-official diagnostic,

$$B_{i,t}^{before\ GFCF} = B_{i,t} + GFCF_{i,t},$$

which answers one narrow question: how large is public investment relative to the recorded balance? It is not a golden-rule balance, not a structural balance, and not any published indicator; no fiscal rule in this report is evaluated against it.

Two caveats attach to the diagnostic. GFCF is gross, so no consumption of fixed capital is netted off and the measure overstates the change in the public capital stock. And investment is lumpy: a single-year ratio can be dominated by one project or one reclassification.

Table 12: Fixed-capital-formation diagnostic by sector, 2025.

Sector	Balance (M EUR)	GFCF (M EUR)	Balance before GFCF (M EUR)	GFCF (% GDP)
General Government	2,059	9,167	11,226	2.99
Central Government	-5,636	4,828	-808	1.57
Regional and Local	630	4,236	4,866	1.38
Social Security Funds	7,065	102	7,167	0.03

9 Debt and Stock-Flow Adjustment

Debt dynamics are not the mirror image of the annual balance. The modern CFP tables support the reconciliation

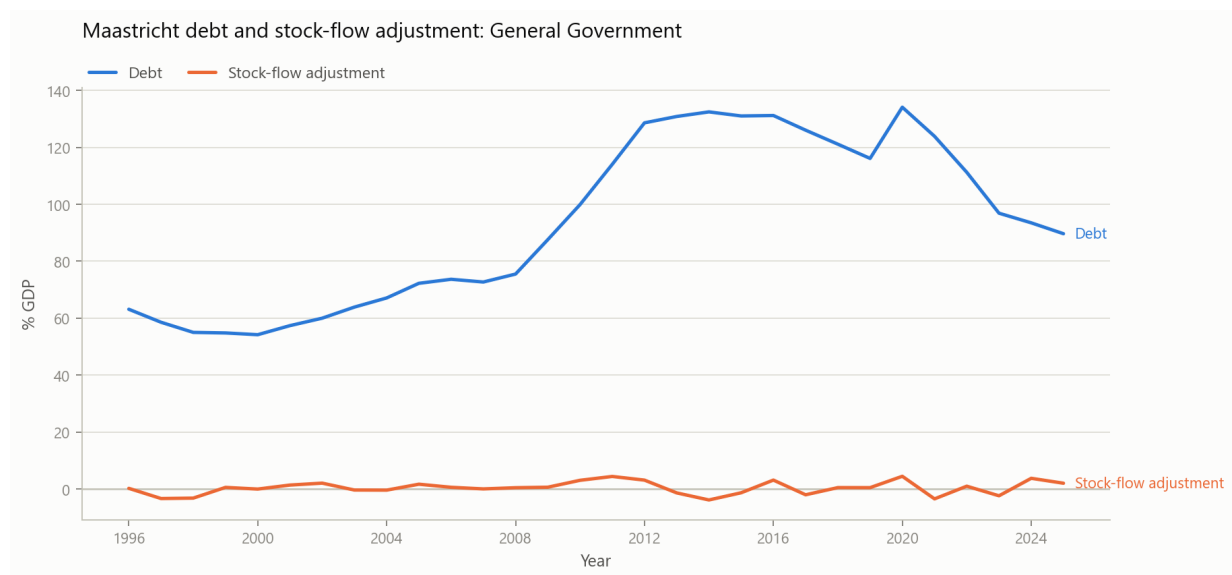
$$\Delta Debt_t = -B_t + SFA_t,$$

where the stock-flow adjustment absorbs everything that changes debt without passing through the balance: financial-asset transactions, valuation effects, timing differences and statistical adjustments. The reconciliation closes to **0.0e+00 M EUR**.

In 2025, General Government Maastricht debt was **89.67% of GDP** and the stock-flow adjustment was **2.03% of GDP**. In several years the adjustment is the larger of the two terms, which is the reason for running the reconciliation at all.

Table 13: General Government debt and stock-flow adjustment, most recent years.

Year	Balance (M EUR)	Change in debt (M EUR)	Stock-flow adj. (M EUR)	Debt (% GDP)	Stock-flow adj. (% GDP)
2016	-3,622	9,449	5,827	131.18	3.13
2017	-5,870	1,904	-3,966	126.03	-2.03
2018	-873	1,879	1,006	121.11	0.49
2019	249	766	1,015	116.11	0.47
2020	-11,564	20,534	8,970	134.10	4.46
2021	-6,117	-1,389	-7,506	123.88	-3.47
2022	-757	3,169	2,412	111.23	0.99
2023	3,030	-9,469	-6,439	96.87	-2.38
2024	1,863	9,013	10,875	93.48	3.75
2025	2,059	4,161	6,219	89.67	2.03

**Figure 9:** General Government Maastricht debt and stock-flow adjustment.

The stock-flow adjustment is a residual category, not a behavioural variable: a large value is a

signal to consult the source documentation, not an anomaly in itself. The debt ratio also moves with nominal GDP, so a falling ratio does not imply falling debt.

10 Persistence and Structural Mean Shifts

10.1 Sign frequencies and runs

Table 14: Sign frequency, average magnitude and longest runs by subsector, over the whole panel.

Sector	N	Positive	Negative	Mean (% GDP)	Median (% GDP)	Longest + run	Longest - run
General Government	49	4	45	-4.915	-5.028	3	42
Central Government	49	0	49	-5.381	-5.396	0	49
Regional and Local	49	18	31	-0.157	-0.124	8	12
Social Security Funds	49	43	6	0.623	0.495	24	2

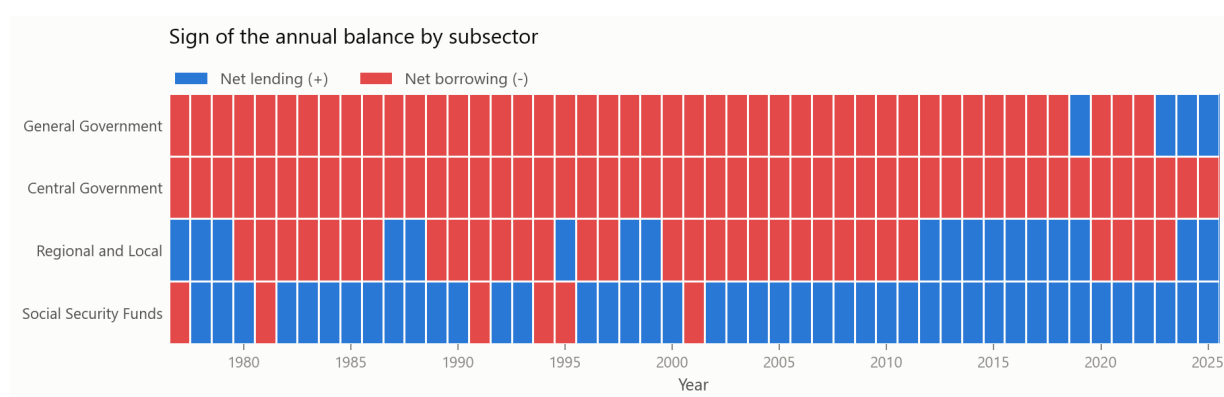


Figure 10: Sign of the annual balance by subsector and year.

Table 15: Empirical one-year sign transition frequencies. Rows sum to one.

Sector	From	To negative	To positive
General Government	negative	0.956	0.044
General Government	positive	0.333	0.667
Central Government	negative	1.000	0.000
Regional and Local	negative	0.839	0.161
Regional and Local	positive	0.294	0.706
Social Security Funds	negative	0.167	0.833
Social Security Funds	positive	0.095	0.905

These are empirical frequencies over the transitions actually observed, not a fitted Markov model: no standard errors and no stationarity test are claimed, and a state that never occurs in the sample has no estimated row. Runs that span 1995 also span the statistical splice.

10.2 Structural mean shifts

Fewer than fifty annual observations, split across two statistical regimes, do not support a flexible change-point model. The specification is therefore deliberately modest: a piecewise-constant mean with at most two breaks per regime, a minimum segment length of five years, exact dynamic-programming minimisation of within-segment squared error, and BIC selection, which may select zero breaks. Detection runs separately on 1977–1994 and 1995–2025, so the known splice is not a candidate economic break by construction.

Table 16: Selected piecewise-constant mean shifts, by statistical regime.

Regime	Sector	N	Breaks	Break years	Segment means (% GDP)
1977-1994 historical	General Government	18	1	1986	-8.0942, -4.7630
1995-2025 modern	General Government	31	2	2009, 2015	-4.3662, -7.9664, -1.4712
1977-1994 historical	Central Government	18	1	1987	-8.1056, -4.7492
1995-2025 modern	Central Government	31	2	2009, 2016	-4.4779, -7.7736, -2.7526
1977-1994 historical	Regional and Local	18	0	–	-0.2750
1995-2025 modern	Regional and Local	31	2	2000, 2011	-0.0006, -0.4598, 0.1550
1977-1994 historical	Social Security Funds	18	0	–	0.4602
1995-2025 modern	Social Security Funds	31	2	2016, 2021	0.3522, 1.0925, 1.8804

The detected dates are statistical summaries. This report attaches no historical cause to any of them, and a five-year minimum segment means shifts near the end of the sample cannot be detected yet.

11 Descriptive Macroeconomic Co-Movement

The full-period specification is

$$B_{i,t}/GDP_t = \alpha_i + \beta_i g_t^{nominal} + \gamma_i I(t \geq 1995) + \epsilon_{i,t},$$

estimated with HAC standard errors. Nominal GDP growth is used because it is the one macroeconomic variable that can be reconstructed on a consistent basis from the bundled sources across the whole panel. It is deliberately not described as an output gap or as a cyclical adjustment, and the regime indicator is a statistical control for the 1995 splice rather than an estimate of a policy change.

Table 17: Descriptive co-movement of subsector balance ratios with nominal GDP growth, HAC standard errors.

Sector	N	R^2	Growth coef.	HAC s.e.	HAC p	Regime coef.
General Government	48	0.1751	7.7012	8.8215	0.3827	3.6653
Central Government	48	0.1634	5.5312	7.6465	0.4695	2.8982
Regional and Local	48	0.0807	-0.0090	0.8348	0.9914	0.2213
Social Security Funds	48	0.0707	2.1789	2.0029	0.2766	0.5458

Table 18: Historical Social Security co-movement with the labour market, 1978–1995, over 18 annual observations.

Quantity	Estimate
R-squared	0.2494
Employment growth coefficient	9.7252
Employment growth, HAC standard error	5.2069
Employment growth, HAC p-value	0.0618
Unemployment rate coefficient	20.2847
Unemployment rate, HAC standard error	8.5997
Unemployment rate, HAC p-value	0.0183

These regressions quantify co-movement. They are not causal estimates: no identification strategy is claimed, the sample is short and serially correlated, and HAC standard errors address

the inference arithmetic rather than small-sample or specification risk. The labour specification rests on eighteen observations and is reported for transparency rather than analytical weight.

12 Intergovernmental Transfers

Historical source tables identify current and capital transfers received and paid between public administrations, which supports a mechanical sensitivity for 1977–1995:

$$B_{i,t}^{sens} = B_{i,t} - (T_{i,t}^{received} - T_{i,t}^{paid}).$$

The result is stored in `outputs/tables/historical_transfer_reallocation_sensitivity.csv`.

It is deliberately not labelled an underlying or true balance, and it is never used to restate B.9 anywhere in this repository. A transfer normally finances an expenditure responsibility assigned to the recipient, so removing the transfer while leaving the responsibility in place does not describe a coherent alternative arrangement. What the sensitivity quantifies is how much the recorded *location* of a balance depends on the transfer convention.

13 Methodological Limitations

1. **1995 is a source and methodology splice**, not an economic event. Both vintages are retained in `data/interim/methodology_overlap_1995.csv` and nothing is smoothed across the boundary.
2. **Detailed subsector accounts have no 1996–1999 observations**. No interpolation is performed, and no statistic is computed across the gap.
3. **Nominal GDP growth is not an output gap**. The co-movement section must not be read as a cyclically adjusted balance.
4. **Social Security national accounts and budget-system accounts have different boundaries**. They are never merged into a single series.
5. **The fixed-investment diagnostic is not an official balance concept**.
6. **Structural-break dates are statistical summaries**, not causal event labels.
7. **Accounting contribution is not causation**. An arithmetic contribution to an aggregate balance is not evidence about intent or responsibility.
8. **Identity and reconciliation residuals validate the extraction**, not the underlying official statistics.
9. All interpretation is restricted to accounting, statistical and economic relationships directly supported by the bundled data.

14 Reproducibility

The repository preserves the raw source workbooks, source-specific intermediate CSVs, the canonical processed panels, every calculated analysis table, the figures, the executed notebooks and a SHA-256 digest of each bundled raw file. The default rebuild is

```
poetry install
make all
```

which runs the deterministic pipeline, executes the notebooks with their outputs stored in place, and runs the test suite. This document is regenerated from the persisted outputs rather than from hard-coded conclusions, and it is built from repository version **0.2.0**.

A Artefact Index

Each section of this report is produced by a notebook and reads a persisted artefact.

Table 19: Report sections mapped to the notebook that produces them and the primary persisted artefact they read.

Section	Notebook	Primary artefact
Data, sources and validation	03_harmonize_and_validate	data/processed/fiscal_balances_1977_2025.csv
Long-run subsector decomposition	04_balance_decomposition	data/processed/annual_balance_metrics_1977_2025.csv
Year-to-year attribution	06_year_to_year_attribution	outputs/tables/balance_change_attribution.csv
Revenue and expenditure dynamics	05_revenue_expenditure	outputs/tables/revenue_expenditure_change_decomposition.csv
Social Security Funds	09_social_security_mechanisms	outputs/tables/social_security_account_metrics.csv
Primary balance and interest	11_primary_balance	outputs/tables/primary_balance_and_interest.csv
Fixed-capital-formation diagnostic	12_investment_diagnostic	outputs/tables/investment_diagnostic.csv
Debt and stock-flow adjustment	13_debt_reconciliation	outputs/tables/debt_stock_flow_reconciliation.csv
Persistence and structural mean shifts	07_persistence, 08_structural_breaks	outputs/tables/persistence_summary.csv
Descriptive macroeconomic co-movement	14_macroeconomic_comovement	outputs/tables/nominal_gdp_balance_comovement.csv
Intergovernmental transfers	10_intergovernmental_transfers	outputs/tables/historical_transfer_reallocation_sensitivity.csv

Notebook names omit the notebooks/ prefix and the .ipynb suffix. Figures are read from outputs/figures/.